

Syllabus

to be in the house because they scattered and hid when the officers arrived. See *Illinois v. Wardlow*, 528 U.S. 119, 124–125. The partygoers’ vague and implausible answers to questioning also gave the officers reason to infer that the partygoers were lying and that their lies suggested a guilty mind. Cf. *Devenpeck v. Alford*, 543 U.S. 146, 149, 155–156. Peaches’ lying and evasive behavior gave the officers reason to discredit everything she said. The officers also could have inferred that she lied when she said she had invited the partygoers to the house, or that she told the partygoers that she was not actually renting the house. Pp. 57–60.

(b) The panel majority failed to follow two basic and well-established principles of law. First, it viewed each fact “in isolation, rather than as a factor in the totality of the circumstances.” *Pringle, supra*, at 372, n. 2. Second, it believed that it could dismiss outright any circumstances that were “susceptible of innocent explanation,” *United States v. Arvizu*, 534 U.S. 266, 277. Instead, it should have asked whether a reasonable officer could conclude—considering all of the surrounding circumstances, including the plausibility of the explanation itself—that there was a “substantial chance of criminal activity,” *Gates, supra*, at 244, n. 13. Pp. 60–62.

2. The officers are entitled to qualified immunity. Pp. 62–68.

(a) As relevant here, officers are entitled to qualified immunity under 42 U.S.C. § 1983 unless the unlawfulness of their conduct was “clearly established at the time,” *Reichle v. Howards*, 566 U.S. 658, 664. To be clearly established, a legal principle must be “settled law,” *Hunter v. Bryant*, 502 U.S. 224, 228, and it must clearly prohibit the officer’s conduct in the particular circumstances before him, see *Saucier v. Katz*, 533 U.S. 194, 202. In the warrantless arrest context, “a body of relevant case law” is usually necessary to “‘clearly establish’ the answer” with respect to probable cause. *Brosseau v. Haugen*, 543 U.S. 194, 199.

Even assuming that the officers lacked actual probable cause to arrest the partygoers, they are entitled to qualified immunity because, given “the circumstances with which [they] w[ere] confronted,” they “reasonably but mistakenly conclude[d] that probable cause [wa]s present.” *Anderson v. Creighton*, 483 U.S. 635, 640, 641. The panel majority and the partygoers have failed to identify a single precedent finding a Fourth Amendment violation “under similar circumstances.” *White v. Pauly*, 580 U.S. 73, 79. And this is not an “obvious case” where “a body of relevant case law” is unnecessary. *Brosseau, supra*, at 199. Pp. 62–65.

(b) Instead of following this straightforward analysis, the panel majority reasoned that, under clearly established District law, a suspect’s